

8.5 Pictures and ClipArt

The Pictures and Clipart functionality seems to have been tightly integrated to the Microsoft Web site in this latest edition of Excel. What is good to see is that searching for either clipart or images allows you to also choose from Microsoft's online collection. It is good to see that there are approximately 1,50,000 images and sounds available at the Microsoft Office Web site; quite a few of them are royalty-free.

There is robust support for image files too. All image file extensions are supported, including the Macintosh PICT and WordPerfect Graphics formats. What this essentially means is that if you have a spreadsheet that was, say, created on a Macintosh with pictures saved in the .pict extension, you wouldn't need to have QuickTime installed to view those images correctly. They will appear correctly without any need for third-party software.

Another wonderful feature with Picture and ClipArt is that it is integrated into all the new and wonderful formatting options available with Excel 2007. What that means is that an unlimited number of style variations can be applied to your picture or clipart.



Notice how you get the option to even search the Web for a particular ClipArt